

**1951 Joins European** Coal and Steel Community.

**1953–2001 The prime minister** changes 35 times during this period, a sign of the shifting political allegiances and the revolving-door principle of Italian government. Amintore Fanfani is prime minister on five separate occasions between 1954 and 1987, often for no more than a few months at a time, and also serves as interim president in 1978.

**1957 Treaty of Rome signed** as Italy becomes a founder member of the EEC. Aided by funds from that organization, industrial growth accelerates.



#### The Treaty of Rome

At the signing of the Treaty of Rome on March 25, 1957, Italy became one of the founder members of the European Economic Community, the organization that gave rise to today's European Union. Italy has remained a fervent member ever since, as its economy, industry, and infrastructure have all benefited massively from membership.

**1963 DC government under** Aldo Moro forms coalition with Socialist Party (PSI).

**1970 Red Brigades**, an extreme-left terrorist group, are formed.

**1972 Support for extreme** right reaches post-war peak (9 percent). Rise in urban terrorism by extreme left and right.

**1976 Communist Party (PCI)** support reaches a peak of 34 percent under Enrico Berlinguer, a proponent of moderate communist policies.

**1978 Aldo Moro abducted** and murdered by Red Brigades.

**1980 Extreme-right bombing** of Bologna station kills 84, wounds 200.

**1983–87 Center-left coalition** formed under Bettino Craxi of the PSI.

**1990 Reactionary Northern League** led by Umberto Bossi attacks immigration policies and subsidies for the south and demands independence for the rich north of the country; this demand is later toned down to demand more autonomy and financial control.

**1992 Corruption scandal**, involving bribes for public contracts, uncovered in Milan. Government members of all parties are accused of receiving kickbacks. Former prime minister Craxi is convicted, while another former prime minister, Giulio Andreotti, is brought to trial accused of dealing with the Sicilian Mafia.

**1994 DC support collapses:** a coalition government is formed between the newspaper magnate Silvio Berlusconi's Forza Italia, the Northern League, and neo-fascist Northern Alliance.

**1995–96 Technocrat government** under Lamberto Dini tackles the budget, pensions, media, and regional issues, after the Northern League leaves Berlusconi's government, causing it to fall.

**1996 Center-left Olive Tree** alliance wins general election; Romano Prodi becomes prime minister and successfully steers the economy so that Italy qualifies for euro membership in 1999.

**1999 Prodi government** falls; he is replaced by Massimo D'Alema as prime minister.

**2000 D'Alema replaced by** Giuliano Amato.

**2001 Berlusconi returns** to power to lead a right-wing coalition in general election.

**2002 Italy joins the euro**, but it struggles to solve its economic problems.

**2005 Conscription into** the armed services ends.

**2006 Berlusconi narrowly loses** the general election to the center-left Union coalition led by Romano Prodi. When he leaves office, Berlusconi has been the longest-serving Italian prime minister since 1945. The new government has a working majority of 67 in the Chamber of Deputies but only 2 in the Senate.

**2007 Prodi resigns** after failing to obtain Senate support for the continuation of US bases in the country,

but is asked to form a new government by the president.

**2008 Berlusconi is reelected** for a third term as prime minister.

**2009 An earthquake** hits Abruzzo, leaving hundreds dead.

«106–07 The Rise of Rome  
«108–09 Julius Caesar  
«110–13 From Republic to Empire  
«150–51 Decline and Fall  
«188–91 Medieval Europe  
«250–53 The Renaissance  
«254–55 Leonardo da Vinci  
«386–87 Fascism

## Vatican City



**The world's smallest state and one of the only two theocracies; the other is Iran.**

**324–49 Roman emperor Constantine** the Great builds a basilica over the traditional burial place of St. Peter, replacing the earlier 2nd-century shrine.

**756 Donation of Pippin** provides legal basis for papal dominion in central Italy.

**1417 After the pope's** return from Avignon in France at the end of the 39-year Great Schism, they take up residence in the Vatican Palace.

**1869–70 First Vatican Council** expounds doctrine of papal infallibility.

**1870 Italian forces enter** Rome, ending papal temporal power in Italy. The pope is left as a self-imposed captive in Rome.

**1929 Lateran Treaty:** Italy accepts the Vatican City as an independent state,

consisting of St. Peter's Basilica, ten other buildings in Rome, and the pope's summer residence at Castel Gandolfo. The Holy See is located in the Vatican City.

**1939–58 Pope Pius XII** is heavily criticized for failing to take action over the Holocaust during World War II.

**1958–63 Reforming papacy** of Pope John XXIII.

**1963–78 Paul VI** is pope; he is succeeded by John Paul I, who dies within a month.

**1978 Polish cardinal** Karol Wojtyla becomes Pope John Paul II, the first non-Italian pope since 1523.

**1981–82 Attempts on pope's** life.

**1984 Catholicism disestablished** as the Italian state religion.

**1985 Catholic catechism** revised for the first time since 1566.

**1994–95 Opposition to abortion** and contraception reiterated.

**1998 Statement repenting** Catholic passivity during the Holocaust.

**2000 Jubilee Year:** a papal apology is made for Catholic violence and oppression over two millennia.

**2001 John Paul II** is first pope to enter a mosque.

**2005 John Paul II dies;** Cardinal Joseph Ratzinger of Germany is elected Pope Benedict XVI after four ballots of the College of Cardinals and establishes himself as a conservative in theological affairs.

#### St. Peter's Basilica

Most of the great architects, artists, and sculptors of the Renaissance were involved in the design and building of St. Peter's, which took more than a century to complete. The basilica and its public square lie at the heart of the Vatican City.

